

8.3 Spam and Phishing tools

Spam has been around almost ever since we've had email addresses. To avoid those unneeded mortgage advantages you receive everyday in myriads, there are several counter-measures. If you use Web-based e-mail, chances are some filters are already protecting you. But those using the ISP's POP3 and SMTP services are at the mercy of spam. It always helps to use a collection of filters for guarding your inbox, and free software is around the block once again.

8.3.1 Spamoto

The punchline "Spam will have been" prepares the stage for the show. A haven for Java folks, it is an extension for most popular e-mail clients such as Thunderbird, MS Outlook, and Mozilla Mail, and is also available as a stand-alone proxy component. It comes packed with six default filters contrary to the one or two used in many others. So instead of electing individual winners, let's see what it takes to get Spamoto running. Start with www.spamato.net and look up the Downloads and Installation section.

8.3.1.1 Installation and setting up

From the many options, Mozilla Thunderbird qualifies as one of the most appreciated open source e-mail clients. The prerequisites for Spamoto are the Java Runtime Environment (JRE 1.5) i.e. J2SE 5.0, downloadable from www.java.com/en/download/windows_ie.jsp, and the



Installing Spamoto on Thunderbird

Thunderbird e-mail client. For MS Outlook (except Outlook 2000, which is not supported), you will also need the .NET Framework (> 1.1) which you can get from the Microsoft Web site (no validation required for Ver. 1.1, only the 22 MB effort!). For Macs and other e-mail clients, Spamatoxy is available.